

BATTERY

Coming to battery, the battery backup is great. The bigger battery unit has definitely worked well as the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro easily lasts about a day and a half, even on heavy usage. During my brief time with the device, I easily got over 7 hours of on-screen time on a single charge after using both screens here and there. This is great battery life for the device. Coming to more objective stuff, the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro only lost 4 percent of the battery while streaming an HDR video in 2160p resolution on YouTube for 30 minutes. A 15-minute gaming session of Call Of Duty: Mobile only drained 4 percent of the battery, and GPS navigation for 1 hour lost xx amount of battery on the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro.

In my charging test, the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro charged from 0 to 100 in 39 minutes, thanks to the 100W fast charging support.

The battery is actually very good on the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro. Even the last 1 percent lasts forever. Similar to the Oppo Find X7 Ultra, the last 1 percent on the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro last enough for you to comfortably reach a charger while using the device. It was difficult to kill the battery on this smartphone after the last 1%, basically.

CAMERA

Camera is where Vivo has not disappointed me in the last couple of years at least. The Vivo X Fold 3 Pro is also similar. We are getting a flagship-level triple rear camera setup with the critically-acclaimed Zeiss collaboration. If you have read my review of the Vivo X100 Pro, you will have an idea about the features offered by Zeiss and Vivo and how much I like them. But if you haven't, I'll tell you.

First and foremost, there are two colour profiles that you can use - Zeiss Natural and Zeiss Vibrant, where the natural tone give a more true-to-life colour to the photos, and the "vibrant" tone makes the colours more vibrant.

Then come the Zeiss optics like the multi-focal portraits or the portrait styles like Biotar or Sonnar or Cine Flare, or more. In this smartphone, the collab with Zeiss goes as deep as the last two flagships from Vivo. Before I tell you how the camera performs, let's

get the specifications out of the way. We are getting a triple rear camera setup with the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro. There is a primary 50-megapixel shooter, a 64-megapixel periscope telephoto shooter, and a 50-megapixel ultrawide angle lens. There are two front cameras on the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro, one on the outer display and one on the main display. Both are 32-megapixel shooters with similar quality.

Now while we are getting features that are similar to the Vivo X100 Pro flagship, does the X Fold 3 Pro's camera also perform similarly? Short answer is no. While it is a very good camera, it isn't as good as the Vivo X100 Pro.

Yes, there are a lot of things similar, but the quality of images isn't the best. For example, I felt that there is a lot of smoothening happening with faces. Even in portraits, where the Vivo X100 Pro is one of the best smartphones out there, the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro smoothen the skin. Not that the portraits are bad, even turning the beauty filter all the way down does smoothen the skins a little bit, but it's not a deal breaker. The portraits are still good, just the details aren't as sharp as the Vivo X100 Pro.

Further, I felt that the processing takes a bit long. Here also, portraits are the ones that take the most amount of time. But then again, once the processing is done, the results are outstanding.

Now that we are done with the criticism, it's time to show you what this camera does well. Apart from the things mentioned above, it does everything pretty well. The details are prominent. Low light photos are brilliant. Photos from the wide angle shooter are also good in terms of details and colours and there is consistency between the two in ideal lighting conditions. In low light, the ultra-wide doesn't showcase the same level of quality.

The photos from the primary shooter and telephoto are amazing, as usual. I really enjoyed clicking photos on this smartphone - be it clicking a scenery in 1x or be it clicking something that's afar with 10x optical zoom. It may not be the best Vivo camera but it is exactly as fun as using any other Vivo flagship camera. Why I think the quality isn't up to the

standard Vivo has set itself could be because the brand is using Ominivision lenses as compared to the Sony lenses in other X-series smartphones. Further, the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chip could also not be tuned to Vivo's requirements, something we have seen the MediaTek Dimensity 9300 ace in the previous X-series flagship from Vivo that I have used.

Nevertheless, the photos are very good in every focal lengths. Despite the smoothening, the portraits look straight out of a professional camera, and we get all the Zeiss smarts that we have come to know in the last few years with Vivo smartphones, especially flagships. It is safe to say that this is the best foldable camera so far.

VERDICT

So that was the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro. It is the most refined foldable that I have used so far. It is easy to hold and grip, it has a brilliant display both inside and out, and it is very powerful at the same time. Couple of things that I didn't like in terms of performance and how the phone functions are firstly, I don't like the whole look and feel of Vivo's FunTouch OS (that is my personal preference, I'm sure many users prefer this) and secondly, I found the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro heats up often.

Apart from that, we are getting an extremely sleek and refined foldable experience. Add to that one of the great camera setups out there and we have a winner. I am using the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro as my primary and I don't think that will change anytime soon since it is no different than using a glass slab phone when folded and when unfolded, it is nothing short of a multi-tasking beast!

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 750 | OS: FunTouch OS 14 based on Android 14 | Display: 6.53-inch FHD+ AMOLED display/ 8.03-inch QHD LTPO AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz/ 120Hz | RAM: 16GB | ROM: 512GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 64MP + 50MP | Cameras (front): 32MP | Video: 8K @ 30fps | Battery: 5700mAh | Charging: 100W

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